Choose a question. Find two passages.

HIST 212 · Question and evidence · Due November 3

Choose one row. Read the suggested passages in our course readings. Then write your one-page submission using the four steps below.

QUESTION	START WITH THIS EVIDENCE
POLITICS **Why wasn't there another Qin—or was there?**	Li Si's two memorials (SCT 207–212): centralized rule. Lu Jia, opening of the Han philosophy packet: lessons from Qin's failure.
POLITICS **Do people behave better because of virtue or punishment?**	Kongzi, Analects 2.3: virtue and shame. Han Feizi, ch. 7, "The Two Handles" (p. 333): punishment and reward.
CULTURE **What ancient ideas still live on now?**	Start with family duty: Analects 1.2 and Wŏn'gwang's Five Commandments (SKT 45–46). Compare what each asks people to do.
CULTURE **Should religious people obey rulers?**	Huiyuan, "A Monk Does Not Bow Down Before a King" (SCT 427–429); Wŏn'gwang's response to the war-petition request (SKT 45).
WAR **Can a war be just?**	Mozi, ch. 17 (p. 73): attacking another state. Salt and Iron (CC 61): the minister's defense of frontier military spending.
WAR **Is a strong army the same as a strong society?**	Lord Shang, 3.2 (p. 134): agriculture and warfare. Mozi, ch. 17 (p. 73): the harm of aggressive war.
ECONOMICS **Should the government run the economy?**	Salt and Iron (CC 61): compare the minister's defense of monopolies with the learned men's objections. Two passages; one source.
ECONOMICS **Would people be better off if rulers did less?**	Laozi 37 (p. 189): a world that orders itself. Taika reform edicts (SJT 77–79): registers, land, and limits on powerful households.

Finish the homework

1. State your question. Choose one above, adapt it, or propose your own.

2. Give your tentative answer. Write one or two sentences that answer the question. You can change your answer after reading.

3. Present and explain passage 1. Copy a short quotation and give its source and page/section. Identify who is speaking and the situation. Explain what the words show about your question.

4. Present and explain passage 2. Do the same for a second passage. Explain how it supports, challenges, or changes your answer.

Before you submit: check both quotations and citations. Explain the evidence; do not just paste it. Submit about one page through the Question and evidence assignment in Canvas.

Later, for the final project: expand to two periods, three East Asian societies, and four primary sources, with an evidenced connection to the present. You do not need that complete comparison in this first submission.